27.1 Understanding the ASP.NET Core hosting model

If you think back to part 1 of this book, you may remember that we discussed the hosting model of ASP.NET Core. ASP.NET Core applications are, essentially, console applications. They have a `static void Main` function that is the entry point for the application, as a standard .NET console app would.

NOTE The entry point for programs using top-level statements is automatically generated by the compiler. It's not called `Main` (it typically has an "invalid" name, such as `<Main>$`), but otherwise it has the same signature as the classic `static void Main` function you would write by hand.

What makes a .NET app an ASP.NET Core app is that it runs a web server, typically Kestrel, inside the console app process. Kestrel provides the HTTP functionality to receive requests and return responses to clients. Kestrel passes any requests it receives to the body of your application and generates a response, as shown in figure 27.1. This hosting model decouples the server and reverse proxy from the application itself so that the same application can run unchanged in multiple environments.

ASP.NET Core apps can be exposed directly to the network to handle requests.

